

INFORMATION REPORT

CD NO

CONFIDENTIAL

COUNTRY: Indochina

DATE DISTR. 27 Dec 50

SUBJECT: Status of Prominent Lao Official on Situation in Laos

NO. OF PAGES 2

25X1 PAGE
REQUIRED

REF ID: A66444 LIBRARY

NO. OF ENCLS.
(LISTED BELOW)DATE OF
INFO.SUPPLEMENT TO
REPORT NO.

25X1

25X1

THIS IS UNEVALUATED INFORMATION

1. Internal Political Situation. The present Lao Government in Vientiane has the support of the King, of Prince Souvanna, of the French, and of the majority of Laotians. The Laos accept the French control of the Government because of the economic advantages and because they fear future domination by the Vietnamese or the Thais.
2. Leaders of the opposition party are represented in the Government. The party is in contact with the Viet Minh and is able to carry on an active campaign against the government, because of the official immunity of their leaders. The chief of the party is in Bangkok, where he maintains liaison with Nguyen Van Thuy, Ho Chi Minh representative in Thailand.
3. Former Free Lao leaders are no longer trusted by the Laos, who consider them opportunists, working only for their own interests.
 - a) Prince Sourkhanvong has been discredited because of his cooperation with the Viet Minh.
 - b) Prince Patcharot has lost the support of the Laos, which he enjoyed during the French protectorate, because of his maltreatment of civil servants. Prince Patcharot is obliged to remain in Thailand because of his disagreement with Prince Savang. He accepts money from the French and the Thais, as well as from the Viet Minh.
 - c) Fieldier Phungkhot has urged the Laos to continue their struggle against the Government and the French, and accuses the Americans of being imperialists.
4. Lao-Tanara Government. The formation of the new Lao-Tanara Government has been unconfirmed. If it does exist, it is probably headed by Prince Savanaphoua, who hopes to head the Council of Ministers. He is now in Sam Khoua.

CONFIDENTIAL

CLASSIFICATION

DATE	BY	REASON	REMARKS
10/16/50	APR	FM	

This document is hereby regraded to
CONFIDENTIAL in accordance with the
letter of 16 October 1975 from the
Director of Central Intelligence to the
Secretaries of the United States.

CONFIDENTIAL INTELLIGENCE AGENCY

CONFIDENTIAL

25X1

25X1

5. Viet Nam headquarters in Laos have not yet been identified. The three possibilities of its whereabouts are:

- a) Between Vientiane and Luang Prabang.
- b) Sam Neua, on the Laos-Thailand frontier.
- c) In Champasak Province.

6. The Lao Army. The Lao Army has been recently reorganized, and totals about 10,000 troops. Only two battalions of the army have been equipped with American arms. The French, leaving their themselves, are unable to advise the Lao forces. The absence of American aid has surprised both the Lao and the French. The Lao are waiting for American aid in the form of money, arms, and troops. With their present equipment, the Lao Army could not possibly resist a Chinese invasion.

25X1

7. The Lao do not consider the French their enemy, because if the French were to leave Indochina, Laos would be invaded by the Vietnamese and the Thai. Under the French-controlled Government, however, the Lao feel that their internal independence is assured.

25X1C

Comment. The establishment of the Provisional Government of Laos, under Prince Souphommavong, was first mentioned in a broadcast of the Viet Nam Radio Agency on 15 October 1950. A subsequent broadcast, on 15 November 1950, stated that the National Assembly met for the first time in mid-August 1950.

CONFIDENTIAL

25X1